



REFUGEE & IMMIGRANT-LED ORGANIZATIONS COALITION (RILOC)

ORGANIZATIONAL PORTFOLIO

Motto/Slogan: Building Thriving Communities Together.

Contacts: info@riloc.org

+1 336 486 7133

Website: www.riloc.org

Current Address: 2251 Copperstone Dr. Apt. 3B, High Point, NC 27265

Nonprofit Registration Number: C202619401248-1

EIN: 42-4249081



ABOUT THE ORGANIZATION

Refugee & Immigrant-Led Organizations Coalition (RILOC) is a nonprofit consortium founded in North Carolina, USA, in 2025 by a diverse group of immigrants, refugees, and U.S. citizens united by a shared commitment to community empowerment, inclusion, equity, and sustainable development.

RILOC was established on the belief that individuals and organizations with lived experience of migration are uniquely positioned to understand the challenges, aspirations, and opportunities within refugee and immigrant communities. Rather than speaking for communities, RILOC seeks to strengthen the capacity of refugee- and immigrant-led organizations to lead, organize, advocate, collaborate, and create sustainable solutions for their own communities.

RILOC brings together community-based organizations, leaders, advocates, professionals, and partners committed to building stronger and more inclusive communities. Through capacity building, leadership development, economic empowerment, youth development, community integration, civic engagement, advocacy, and strategic partnerships, RILOC works to expand the ability of community-led organizations to create lasting social and economic impact.

Our work is grounded by a simple philosophy:

Communities are strong when the people most affected by challenges are empowered to help lead the solutions.

Founded in North Carolina, RILOC has a broader vision: to develop a collaborative network of refugee- and immigrant-led organizations capable of sharing knowledge, resources, leadership, and opportunities across communities and, ultimately, across the United States.

2. OUR STORY

RILOC emerged from the recognition that refugee and immigrant-led organizations often possess deep community knowledge and strong relationships with the populations they serve, yet may face



barriers to organizational capacity, funding, leadership development, networking, and institutional visibility.

The founders envisioned an organization that would help bridge this gap.

In 2025, immigrants, refugees, and U.S. citizens in North Carolina came together to establish RILOC as a consortium focused not only on serving communities, but on strengthening the organizations that are already rooted within those communities.

RILOC therefore operates from a consortium perspective: connect, strengthen, empower, and amplify.

Our long-term goal is to help create an ecosystem in which refugee and immigrant-led organizations can access the knowledge, resources, partnerships, and opportunities necessary to become stronger and more sustainable institutions.

3. OUR MISSION

To empower refugee and immigrant-led organizations and the communities they serve through capacity building, leadership development, economic empowerment, advocacy, and strategic partnerships.

4. OUR VISION

To create inclusive, resilient, and empowered communities where refugee and immigrant-led organizations have the capacity, resources, and leadership necessary to shape their own futures and contribute meaningfully to the society.

5. OUR CORE VALUES

Inclusion

We believe everyone deserves to participate fully in the social, economic, civic, and community life of society.

Empowerment

We prioritize approaches that enable individuals and organizations to develop their own capacity and exercise leadership.



Equity

We work to identify and address barriers that prevent communities from accessing opportunities and resources.

Integrity

We promote honesty, transparency, accountability, and responsible stewardship of resources.

Collaboration

We believe lasting change is strengthened through partnerships, shared knowledge, and collective action.

Respect for Lived Experience

We recognize refugees and immigrants as leaders, contributors, advocates, and decision-makers—not simply beneficiaries.

Sustainability

We seek solutions that strengthen organizations and communities for the long term.

6. THE CHALLENGE WE ADDRESS

Refugee and immigrant communities contribute significantly to the social, cultural, and economic life of communities across the United States. At the same time, many community-led organizations face challenges that can limit their ability to grow and sustain their work.

These challenges may include:

- Limited organizational and administrative capacity
- Difficulty accessing sustainable funding
- Limited fundraising and grant-writing capacity
- Leadership development gaps
- Limited access to professional networks and strategic partnerships



- Challenges with program development and evaluation
- Limited institutional visibility
- Barriers to economic opportunity
- Language and cultural barriers
- Limited opportunities for civic participation and community leadership

RILOC exists to help address these structural and organizational challenges by strengthening the organizations closest to the communities they serve.

7. OUR APPROACH

RILOC uses a community-led and coalition-based approach.

Rather than imposing solutions from outside communities, we seek to work alongside refugee and immigrant-led organizations to identify needs, develop organizational capacity, share resources, build partnerships, and create sustainable opportunities.

Our approach is built around five philosophical aspects:

LISTEN → CONNECT → STRENGTHEN → COLLABORATE → AMPLIFY

We listen to communities, connect organizations with resources and one another, strengthen organizational capacity, facilitate collaboration, and amplify community-led solutions.

8. STRATEGIC PRIORITIES

8.1 Organizational Capacity Building

RILOC supports organizations in strengthening their internal systems, governance, administration, financial management, strategic planning, program development, fundraising, communications, and evaluation capacity.



8.2 Leadership Development

We support emerging and established leaders through training, mentorship, networking, leadership development, and opportunities for collaborative learning.

8.3 Economic Empowerment & Entrepreneurship

RILOC promotes economic opportunity through entrepreneurship initiatives, workforce development, financial literacy, business education, and connections to economic resources.

8.4 Youth Education & Mentorship

We seek to equip young people with leadership skills, educational opportunities, mentorship, civic awareness, and pathways toward future success.

8.5 Community Integration & Social Cohesion

We promote meaningful relationships among refugee, immigrant, and U.S.-born communities by supporting cultural exchange, dialogue, inclusion, and community engagement.

8.6 Civic Engagement & Legal Awareness

RILOC promotes civic participation and helps communities understand available resources, rights, responsibilities, and pathways for constructive engagement with institutions.

8.7 Advocacy & Strategic Partnerships

We work to elevate the voices of refugee- and immigrant-led organizations and connect them with nonprofit, governmental, philanthropic, academic, corporate, and community partners.



9. WHO WE SERVE

RILOC's primary beneficiaries include:

- Refugee-led organizations
- Immigrant-led organizations
- Community-based organizations
- Emerging grassroots organizations
- Refugee and immigrant leaders
- Youth and young adults
- Underserved communities
- Families and individuals experiencing barriers to opportunity

Our work also benefits the broader communities in which refugee and immigrant populations live, work, study, worship, and contribute.

10. THE RILOC COALITION MODEL

RILOC is designed to function as a network and coalition, creating opportunities for organizations to learn from one another rather than working in isolation.

Through the coalition model, members can potentially benefit from:

- Shared knowledge and technical assistance
- Capacity-building opportunities
- Leadership development
- Collaborative fundraising
- Resource sharing
- Peer learning



- Joint initiatives
- Strategic partnerships
- Increased organizational visibility
- Collective advocacy
- Opportunities to participate in larger projects and initiatives

The coalition model allows organizations to maintain their individual identities while working collectively toward shared goals.

11. PARTNERSHIPS

RILOC believes that sustainable community development requires collaboration across sectors.

We seek partnerships with:

- Foundations and philanthropic institutions
- Federal, state, and local government agencies
- Universities and colleges
- Nonprofit organizations
- Faith-based organizations
- Corporations and businesses
- Community foundations
- International development organizations
- Professional associations
- Refugee and immigrant-led organizations
- Community leaders and advocates



Our goal is to build partnerships based on shared objectives, mutual respect, transparency, and measurable community impact.

12. FUNDING & SUSTAINABILITY

RILOC seeks to develop a diversified and sustainable funding model that may include:

- Foundation grants
- Government grants and contracts
- Corporate partnerships
- Individual philanthropy
- Membership and coalition contributions
- Program-related funding
- Strategic partnerships
- Community fundraising
- Collaborative grant opportunities

RILOC is committed to responsible stewardship, transparency, accountability, and using resources strategically to strengthen the organizations and communities within its network.

13. GOVERNANCE & ORGANIZATIONAL DEVELOPMENT

RILOC is committed to developing strong governance systems that promote:

- Accountability
- Transparency
- Ethical leadership
- Responsible financial management
- Community representation



- Strategic decision-making
- Organizational sustainability

As RILOC grows, its governance and operational structures will continue to evolve to support its expanding coalition and geographic reach.

14. GEOGRAPHIC SCOPE & GROWTH

RILOC was founded in North Carolina and begins its work from the state's diverse refugee and immigrant communities.

Our long-term vision is to develop a broader network connecting refugee- and immigrant-led organizations across the United States, creating opportunities for organizations to collaborate beyond geographic boundaries.

The growth of RILOC will be guided by organizational capacity, community needs, strategic partnerships, and sustainable resources.

15. OUR EXPECTED IMPACT

Through its work, RILOC seeks to contribute to:

- Stronger refugee- and immigrant-led organizations
- Increased organizational sustainability
- Greater access to funding and resources
- Stronger community leadership
- Increased economic opportunities
- Greater youth engagement and leadership
- Stronger community integration
- Increased civic participation
- More effective collaboration among organizations
- Greater visibility of refugee- and immigrant-led solutions



Ultimately, our measure of success will not simply be how much RILOC accomplishes as an organization, but how much stronger the organizations and communities within our network become.

16. WHY PARTNER WITH RILOC?

RILOC offers partners an opportunity to invest directly in community-led leadership and organizational sustainability.

By supporting RILOC, partners can contribute to an ecosystem in which refugee- and immigrant-led organizations are better equipped to:

Lead. Organize. Innovate. Advocate. Collaborate. Thrive.

Partnership with RILOC means investing not only in individual programs, but in the long-term capacity of organizations that are deeply connected to the communities they serve.

17. OUR COMMITMENT

RILOC is committed to building an organization characterized by integrity, inclusion, accountability, collaboration, and measurable impact.

We recognize that sustainable change does not happen overnight. It requires relationships, trust, resources, leadership, and a commitment to learning.

We therefore invite organizations, institutions, funders, businesses, government agencies, and community leaders to join us in building stronger and more inclusive communities.

18. CALL TO PARTNERSHIP

BUILD WITH US.

RILOC welcomes organizations and partners who share our commitment to empowering refugee and immigrant communities.



Whether through funding, technical assistance, mentorship, training, advocacy, research, volunteerism, or strategic collaboration, there is an opportunity to contribute.

Together, we can strengthen organizations.

Together, we can empower communities.

Together, we can build sustainable futures.

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Founded in North Carolina, USA | 2025